The Scrum Game

The Scrum Game is a training game for 2 to 8 players. The game is an introduction to Scrum/Agile project management.

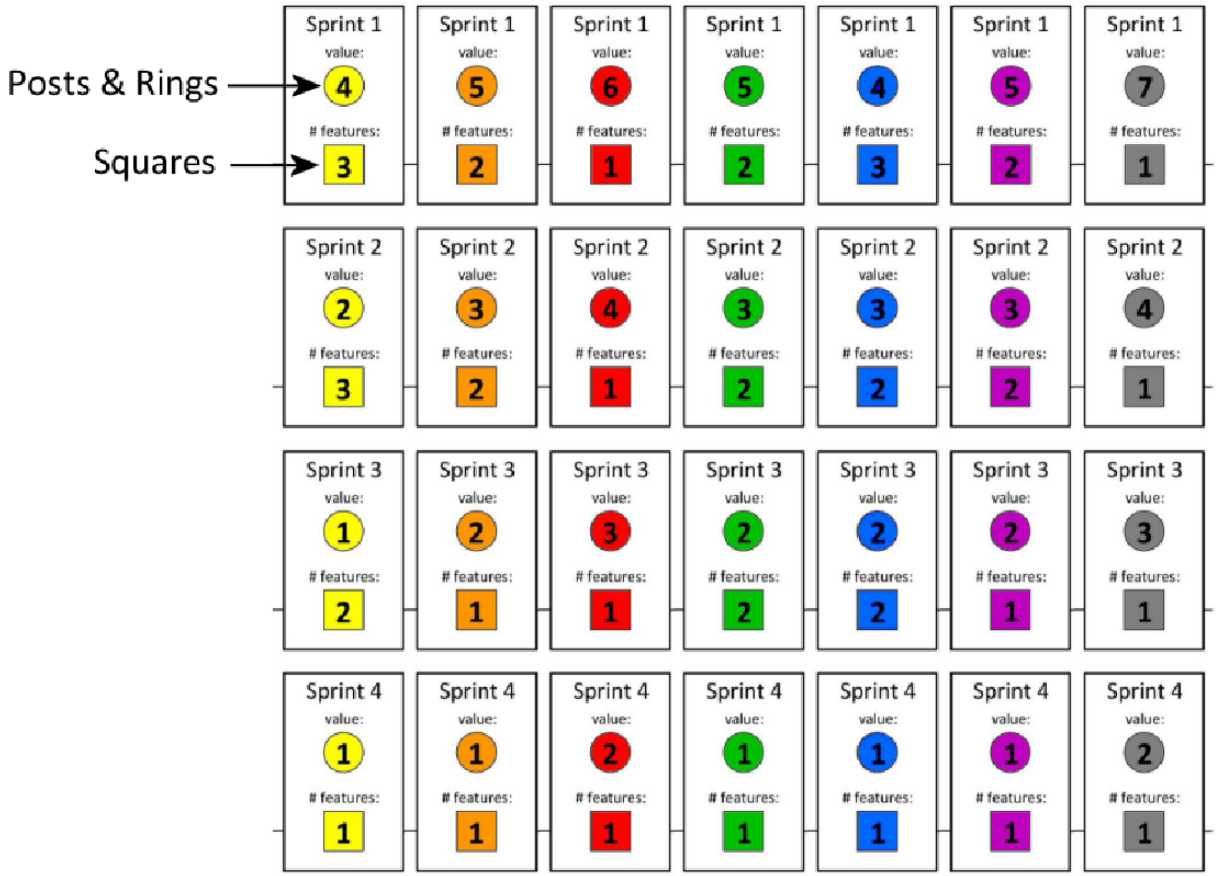
<u>Summary</u>
Every colour on the board corresponds with a product development cycle. To develop and release a product a player must execute sprints. Every sprint has a value and a number of features. If the sprint is completed on time (within planning) the sprint value is collected. Every player may execute 6 – 20 sprints. Advised is to use 6 sprints. The player who makes the best use of the Scrum tools scores the highest feature value after 6 sprints and wins the game.

<u>Strategy</u>
Due to refinement (old name is grooming) and incidents, the sprint value and the number of features in the upcoming sprints may change after every sprint. So the player must adapt his or her strategy. After every sprint the player may decide to execute a further sprint, now the new feature values are given, or release the product and start work on a new product.

Theme: Risk is reduced to one sprint.

Preparation

Place a black post with golden rings in every sprint box on the board, in the coloured circles. The number of golden rings is given in the following illustration. Place a number of black squares in every sprint box. The number of squares is given in the following illustration.



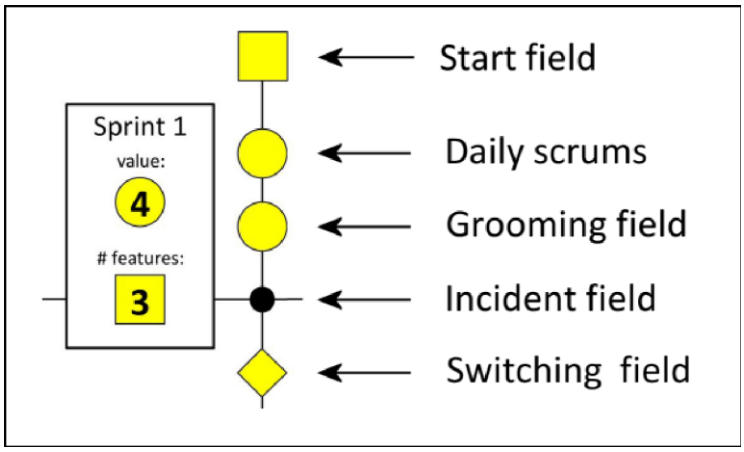
Start

Every player receives 1 pawn, 6 black stacking counters and 25.000 euro.
Place the counters on the board, in the Player Card box, in the black circle.

Every player chooses a product colour. This is the first product to be developed.
Place your pawn in the coloured Start field of the chosen product.
During 1 turn, a player executes 1 complete sprint by taking the following 4 steps:

1. Start the sprint, or switch to another product and start the sprint.
2. Execute 5 daily scrums.
3. Refinement the future sprints.
4. Wait on the incident field.

Every player may execute 6 sprints. Remove a black counter from your stack at the start of every turn. Place your pawn in the corresponding fields on the board when executing a sprint.



After these 4 steps, the next player takes his turn. When all players have completed a turn, all pawns must be on an Incident field.

1. Execute the 5 Daily Scrums.
Are the features in this sprint released on time?
Every daily scrum has a positive or negative effect on the planning.

<u>Step 1.1:</u> Roll the dice 5 times to decide the outcome of the 5 Daily Scrums.
- 1 feature: use the white D-20 die (with numbers from 1 to 20).
- 2 features: use two black D-10 dice (with numbers from 1 to 10).
- 3 features: use three black D-6 dice.
- 4 features: use three black D-6 dice.

Always roll the dice 5 times. The target for every Daily Scrum is 12.
After every roll, place silver counters on the board, in the Player Card box, in the + or – circles.

Example:
You score 16 points in your first roll. That is 4 more than planned. Place 4 counters in the + circle
You score 6 points in your second roll. That is 6 less than planned. Take the 4 counters from the + circle and place 2 counters in the – circle (equals 6). Repeat this 5 times.

<u>Step 1.2:</u> Pay the price if the feature is not released on time.
Pay 1.000 euro for every counter in the + or - circles, after the 5 daily scrums.

<u>Step 1.3:</u> Collect the sprint value.
When a sprint is finished successfully, the sprint value may be collected.
Only when there are no counters in the + circle, the feature is released on time, and the sprint value may be collected. Every golden ring is worth 5.000 euro. Leave the rings on the posts.

2. Refinement to the future sprints
Due to grooming the number of features for future sprints can be increased or decreased.
Refinement : Roll the white D-20 die once to groom, and check the result:

CARD 1:
Yellow, Red Product:
After a score of 1 or 2:
The number of features increases for this product.
Place an extra square on every future sprint for this product.
After a score of 19 or 20:
The number of features decreases for this product.
Take a square from the last sprint.

CARD 2:
Orange, Green, Purple Product:
After a score of 1, 2 or 3:
The number of features increases for this product.
Place an extra square on every future sprint for this product.
After a score of 19 or 20:
The number of features decreases for this product.
Take a square from the last sprint.

CARD 3:
Blue Product:
After a score of 1, 2, 3 or 4:
The number of features increases for this product.
Place an extra square on every future sprint for this product.
After a score of 19 or 20:
The number of features decreases for this product.
Take a square from the last sprint.

CARD 4:
Black Product:
After a score of 1:
The number of features increases for this product.
Place an extra square on every future sprint for this product.
After a score of 20:
The number of features decreases for this product.
Take a square from the last sprint.

3. Handle an incident
When all players have completed a turn, all pawns must be on an Incident field. At this moment one Incident card is drawn and read out loud. This incident may concern different products. After one incident card all players execute the next sprint.

4. Switching
Due to grooming and incidents the number of features for future sprints may change and the feature value may change as well.
At the start of every turn a player has to choose:
Start the next sprint of the chosen product, or switch to another product.

Start the next sprint:	Proceed with the 5 daily scrums and grooming.
Switch to another product:	Place the pawn in the start box of the chosen product, pay the switching costs and start the sprint.
Switching costs:	the value of the next sprint of the abandoned product + 5.000.

Extra:
Any player may lend 50.000 euro from the bank,
with an interest rate of 5.000 euro per turn.

OLD.

Incident 1
The demand of the red product drops dramatically.

The value of the all the future red sprints is now zero.
Take all the rings from the posts of the red product.

Incident 2
Two new competitors enter the markets of the orange and the blue product.

The value of the all the future orange and blue sprints is reduced by 5.000.
Take a ring from the posts of the future sprints of the orange and blue product.

Incident 3
The government starts a campaign to subsidize tech products

The value of the all the first sprints increase by 5.000.
Place a ring on the post of the first sprint of all 7 products.

Incident 4
A breakthrough in a large foreign market gives the demand for the yellow product a boost.

The value of the all the yellow sprints increase by 5.000.
Place a ring on the post of all the yellow sprints.

Incident 5
A spectacular new digital invention increases the value of the black product dramatically.

The value of the fourth black sprint is now 100.000 (20 rings).
Place 20 rings on the post of the black product (use the large post).